Behaloscha 5785

R' Yosef Shlomo Goldstein, the מחבר of a sefer called דברי יושר from the ישיבה in Gateshead, is quoted in the Kol HaTorah journal with the following דבר תורה on this pasuk in בהעלותך (8:19):

וְאַתָּנָה אֶת הַלְוִיִּם נְתֻנִים לְאַהֲרֹן וּלְבָנָיו מִתּוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לַעֲבֹד אֶת עֲבֹדַת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּאֹהֶל מוֹעֵד וּלְכַפֵּר עַל בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְלֹא יִהְיֶה בִּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל נֶגֶף בְּגֶשֶׁת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶל הַקֹּדֶשׁ

We're talking about when the לוים were being prepared to serve in the משכן and eventually in the בית המקדש; וְאֶסְקֹח אֶת הַלְוִיִּם תַּחַת כָּל בְּכוֹר בִּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל - As we know, the לוים replaced the בכורים who lost their opportunity at the חטא העגל. רש"י points out an interesting fact, which is not usual for רש"י, it's more like the בעל הטורים. רש"י points out that it says the words בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל five times in this pasuk, to teach you חיבתן, that Hashem loves all of כלל ישראל:

חֲמִשָּׁה פְּעָמִים נֶאֱמְרוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמִקְרָא זֶה, לְהוֹדִיעַ חִבָּתָן, שֶׁנִּכְפַּל אַזְכָּרוֹתֵיהֶן בְּמִקְרָא אֶחָד כְּמִנְיַן חֲמִשָּׁה חֻמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה, וְכָךְ רָאִיתִי בִּבְבָ"ר

Hashem looks at us just like the חמשה חומשי תורה. What is the implication of that? R' Goldstein explains that it says in פרשת יתרו (שמות י"ט:ה'): וְעַתָּה אִם שָׁמוֹעַ תִּשְׁמְעוּ בְקֹלִי וּשְׁמַרְתֶּם אֶת בְּרִיתִי וְהְיִיתֶם לִי סְגֻלָּה מִכָּל הָעַמִּים כִּי לִי כָּל הָאָרֶץ. רש"י says on the spot over there, סגולה means an אוצר חביב - a wonderful, dear treasure. Just like a סגולת מלכים which is all over תנ"ך, which means a vessel full of precious jewels and precious gems that kings put away in their treasure house, so too Hashem says to כלל ישראל, "You are to me like a סגולה amongst all of the other nations." Why is that? The חיבה that הקדוש ברוך הוא has for כלל ישראל comes from the קבלת התורה of כח. We recently had שבועות with the awesome פגישה between הקדוש ברוך הוא and בני ישראל where we received the תורה. The fact that number one, כלל ישראל received the תורה, and number two, equally as important if not perhaps even more so, that they're עוסקים בתורה. Therefore Hashem has the words בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל five times by the לוים. Why? To show us the אהבה הקדוש ברוך הוא has for his nation כלל ישראל.

Now, why mention it here of all places? Here we're choosing the לוים to be special members of כלל ישראל, and they're picked out to be on a higher מדרגה. They have an even more special בחירה. We're called the עם הנבחר. They have even more special בחירה among כלל ישראל to be משרתים לפני השם. So בני ישראל might have had a little bit of a twinge there to feel that they're not on the same level in חביבות הקדוש ברוך הוא's scale, in the love הקדוש ברוך הוא has for us. Therefore, the pasuk says, each member of כלל ישראל is חביב to הקדוש ברוך הוא. Why? In the זכות of קבלת התורה. The pasuk says the words בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל five times to tell you that the כתר of תורה is superior to any other כתר.We know that in הלכות תלמוד תורה the רמב"ם writes, quoting from פרקי אבות, that there are three כתרים: כתר מלכות, כתר כהונה, כתר תורה, and כתר תורה עולה על כולם. The כתר of כהונה is only for אהרן and his children. The כתר of מלכות is only for דוד and his children, but the כתר of תורה is free and available for each and every member of כלל ישראל. You see that is greater than all of them.

The pasuk teaches us that this is the basis for חיבה הקדוש ברוך הוא's for כלל ישראל. It's brought here, in this specific spot where the לוים are being chosen, because Hashem wants to show us, (and you have to know how to learn and read רש"י to look into the פסוק to show this love for כלל ישראל) that even in an area where part of כלל ישראל is chosen, Hashem says, "I love you all, and I love each and every one with a חביבות because of the זכות of לימוד התורה". In that זכות may we all join in that כתר and may we all benefit from this love that Hashem has for us, both in עולם הזה and in עולם הבא. And hopefully soon when משיח comes, we will see it בחוש.

https://youtu.be/IhAYCqyTSxw